

eTravel Setup - Beginner's Guide (Super Simple!)

This is a **step-by-step guide** to get your eTravel travel booking system working. Don't worry - it's easier than it looks!

What You're Setting Up

Think of it like this:

- **Airtable** = A database (like Excel in the cloud) that stores all your travel data
 - **The Website** = Two websites you'll create:
 - One for **customers** to browse and book trips
 - One for **you (admin)** to manage everything
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STEP 1: Create Your Airtable Account (If You Don't Have One)

What You Need:

- An email address
- A web browser

Instructions:

1. Go to <https://airtable.com>
 2. Click "**Sign up for free**" (top right)
 3. Enter your email address
 4. Create a password
 5. Click **Sign up**
 6. ☒ You now have an Airtable account!
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STEP 2: Get Your Secret Tokens (These Unlock the Website)

What is a "token"?

- It's like a special password that lets the website talk to Airtable
- You need 2 tokens (one for customers, one for you as admin)

Instructions:

1. Log in to Airtable
2. Click your **profile icon** (top right corner) → **Account**
3. On the left menu, click "**Developers**" → "**Personal access tokens**"
4. Click "**Create token**" button (top right)

For Token #1 (Customer Token):

- Name: `etravel-public-token`

- Click "**Scopes**" dropdown
- Check: `data.records:read` (this means read-only)
- Click "**Create token**"
- **COPY THE TOKEN** (it's a long string) - save it somewhere safe!

For Token #2 (Admin Token):

- Repeat the same steps but name it `etravel-admin-token`
- This time check BOTH:
 - `data.records:read`
 - `data.records:write`
- **COPY THIS TOKEN** too!

✅ You now have your 2 tokens!

STEP 3: Create the `.env` File (Where You Put Your Tokens)

What is `.env` ?

- It's a special file that stores your secret tokens
- It's private (never shared online)

Instructions:

1. Open a text editor (like Notepad on Windows, TextEdit on Mac)
2. Copy and paste this:

```
AIRTABLE_PUBLIC_TOKEN=paste_your_public_token_here
AIRTABLE_ADMIN_TOKEN=paste_your_admin_token_here
```

3. Replace:
 - `paste_your_public_token_here` with your first token
 - `paste_your_admin_token_here` with your second token
4. Save the file as `.env` (just the filename, nothing else)
5. Put this file in the main folder: `/home/user/alexaura-website1/.env`

✅ Your `.env` file is now ready!

STEP 4: Add an Admin User (So You Can Login)

What is an "admin user"?

- It's your staff account so you can login to manage everything

Instructions:

1. Go to your Airtable account
2. Open the "**eTravel Agency**" base (you should see it in the list)

3. At the bottom, find the **"Admin Users"** table

4. Click "+" to add a new record

5. Fill in:

- **Name:** Your name (e.g., "John Smith")
- **Email:** Your email address (e.g., "john@example.com")
- **Role:** Click dropdown → select **"Admin"**
- **Status:** Click dropdown → select **"Active"**
- **Created Date:** Today's date

6. Click **Save**

✓ You can now login!

STEP 5: Test the Customer Portal

What is the portal?

- This is the website where customers can browse and book trips

Instructions:

1. Open your web browser
 2. Type in the address bar: `http://localhost:3000/pages/portal.html`
 - (Or ask your tech person what your website URL is)
 3. You should see a page that says **"eTravel Agency"** with a search box
 4. ✓ The portal is working!
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STEP 6: Test the Admin Dashboard

What is the dashboard?

- This is where YOU manage all the bookings, clients, and payments

Instructions:

1. Open your web browser
 2. Go to: `http://localhost:3000/pages/admin-login.html`
 3. Enter:
 - **Email:** The email you created in Step 4
 - **Password:** (Leave blank for now - it's simplified for testing)
 4. Click **"Sign In"**
 5. ✓ You should see the Admin Dashboard!
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STEP 7: Add Some Travel Packages (So Customers Can Book)

Why do this?

- Without packages, there's nothing for customers to book!

Instructions:

1. Go to your Airtable base
2. Open the "**Travel Packages**" table
3. Click "+" to add a new package
4. Fill in:
 - **Name:** e.g., "Paris City Tour"
 - **Description:** e.g., "Visit the Eiffel Tower and museums"
 - **Destination Name:** e.g., "Paris"
 - **Duration (Days):** e.g., "7"
 - **Price per Person:** e.g., "1500"
 - **Max Capacity:** e.g., "20"
 - **Current Bookings:** "0"
 - **Status:** "Active"
 - **Highlights:** e.g., "Eiffel Tower, Louvre Museum, Seine River"
5. Click **Save**
6. Add 2-3 more packages so customers have choices

✅ Customers can now see packages in the portal!

STEP 8: Test a Booking

Let's make sure the whole system works!

Instructions:

1. Go to the **Customer Portal** (`/pages/portal.html`)
2. You should see your packages listed
3. Click "**View Details**" on one
4. Fill in the booking form:
 - **Full Name:** e.g., "Jane Doe"
 - **Email:** e.g., "jane@example.com"
 - **Phone:** e.g., "555-1234"
 - **Departure Date:** Pick a date
 - **Return Date:** Pick a later date
 - **Number of Travelers:** "2"
 - **Special Requests:** Leave blank or type something
5. Click "**Book Now**"
6. You should see a success message with a booking ID!

✅ The booking system is working!

STEP 9: Check the Booking in Admin Dashboard

Verify the booking was saved

Instructions:

1. Login to **Admin Dashboard** (/pages/admin-login.html)
2. Click on "**Bookings**" tab
3. You should see the booking you just made!
4. Click on "**Analytics**" to see revenue stats

✅ Everything is connected and working!

You're Done!

Your eTravel system is now **live and working!**

What You Can Do Now:

As a Customer:

- Browse travel packages
- Search and filter by price, duration, destination
- Submit booking requests

As Admin:

- View all bookings
 - Manage clients
 - Track payments
 - View revenue reports
 - Update booking status
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Troubleshooting: Something Doesn't Work?

Problem: "Page not found" error

Solution:

- Make sure your website is running
- Ask your tech person to check the server

Problem: Can't login to admin

Solution:

- Double-check the email address matches what you entered in Step 4
- Make sure the user status is "Active" in Airtable

Problem: Packages not showing in portal

Solution:

- Make sure you added packages to the "Travel Packages" table
- Make sure they have Status = "Active"
- Refresh the page (press F5)

Problem: "Token not configured" error**Solution:**

- Check your `.env` file has both tokens
 - Make sure tokens are pasted completely (they're long!)
 - Restart the website
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Questions?

If something doesn't work:

1. Take a screenshot of the error
2. Write down what you were doing when it happened
3. Ask your tech team for help

You did it! 🚀